Lesson 10 material: Grammar: Present Tense, Compound Sentences, Adjectives

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 1: People and Places

2.6: Grammar: Present Tense Verbs

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

This lesson is available as slides for classroom presentation.

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Warm-Up

Compare these sentences.

- Every day, I travel from Tijuana to San Diego
- Right now, I am driving to Grossmont College

Study the verbs. What is the difference between the two tenses?

Simple Present and Present Continuous Forms

(Picture: A screenshot of a cell phone Description generated with very high confidence)

Figure

Spelling Rules for Adding -ing to a Verb (Present Participle)

NO CHANGE	**Most verbs**	Add -ing	**Read--Reading**	**Talk--Talking**	**Say--Saying**	**Want--Wanting**		
NO CHANGE	**Verbs that end in -y**	Add -ing	**Study--Studying**	**Carry--Carrying**	**Play--Playing**			
CHANGE	**Verbs that add in -e**	Drop the -e and add -ing	**Wake—Waking**	**Make—Making**	**Tape--Taping**			
CHANGE	**Verbs that end in -ie**	Change the ie to y	**Die—dying**	**Lie—lying**				
CHANGE	**Verbs that end in CVC (consonant, vowel, consonant)**	**1 syllable**	Double the last letter	**Stop—Stopping**	**Sit—Sitting**	**Ban--Banning**		
CHANGE	**Verbs that end in CVC**	**2 syllables**	If the stress is on the last syllable, double the last letter	**Begin—Beginning**	**Refer—Referring**	**BUT**	**Listen—Listening**	**Cancel--Canceling**

Spelling Rules for Adding -s/-es to the End of a Word (Plural Noun or Third Person Singular Simple Present)

Most words	Add -s to the end of the word	**Verbs**	Walk--Walks	Cook--Cooks	Sit--Sits	Run--Runs	**Plural nouns**	Hat--Hats	Table--Tables	Chair--Chairs	Tree--Trees				
Words ending in consonant -y	Change the -y to -ie, then add -s	**Verbs**	Carry--Carries	Study--Studies	Fly--Flies	**Plural Nouns**	Sky--Skies	Belly--Bellies	Rally--Rallies						
Words ending in these consonants	S	X	Ch	Sh	Add -es	**Verbs**	Pass--Passes	Fix—Fixes	Watch—Watches	Bash--Bashes	**Plural Nouns**	Mess—Messes	Tax—Taxes	Patch--Patches	Dish—Dishes

Simple Present Tense Usage

- General facts
  - EX: It never snows in El Cajon
- Routines/habits
  - EX: She drives from Mexico to San Diego once a week
- Permanent situations
  - EX: I live in San Diego
- Stative verbs
  - EX: I don't like the weather in San Diego

Present Continuous Usage

- Actions that are happening right now
  - EX: We are strolling on the beach
- Actions that are in progress
  - EX: This semester, she is working at a restaurant to help pay for school
- Actions that are new or temporary
  - EX: He is living in San Diego; he moved here a few months ago
- Actions that are changing over time
  - EX: Rent in San Diego is increasing rapidly

Contrasting Simple Present and Present Continuous

Simple present is used for permanent situations. Present continuous is used for situations that are new or temporary.

- She works at Ross Dress for Less; she has worked there for a while and plans to stay
- She is working at Ross Dress for Less; she started the job a short time ago, or she plans to change jobs soon

Some verbs are stative. This means they are usually used for a permanent situation. Some of these verbs cannot be used in continuous form; other stative verbs change meaning when they are used in continuous form.

- GOOD EX: I own a car
- BAD EX: I am owning a car
- GOOD EX: I think Balboa Park is beautiful
- BAD EX: I am thinking Balboa Park is beautiful
- GOOD EX: I am thinking about Balboa Park

Learn How to Form Simple Present

Watch this video.

Learn How to Form Present Continuous

Watch this video.

Learn About the Differences Between Simple Present and Present Continuous

Watch this video.

Learn More About Stative Verbs

Watch this video.

Click here for lists and exercises for learning more about stative verbs.

Click here for a list of stative verbs.

Links on the original page

- Slides (Google Slides): https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1G1EEofnKoLwuKa2l0zgVyzFQSNgFzkYYLjczdLJpiYs/edit?usp=sharing
- Video (YouTube): https://youtu.be/bkA8dFYMAZc
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- Video (YouTube): https://youtu.be/AEBRIBtq7q0
- Video (YouTube): https://youtu.be/nFdXIenda98
- Web page (perfect-english-grammar.com): https://www.perfect-english-grammar.com/stative-verbs.html
- Web page (perfect-english-grammar.com): https://www.perfect-english-grammar.com/support-files/stative-verbs-list.pdf

2.7: Grammar: Compound Sentences

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

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Subjects and Verbs

Read these sentences about the history of San Diego. Identify the subject and verb of each sentence. How many subjects and verbs does each sentence have?

- Spanish explorers sailed to San Diego in 1542, but the first residents were Kumeyaay people
- In 1821, Mexico won independence from Spain, and San Diego became part of Mexico
- In 1848, the United States won the Mexican-American War, so San Diego became part of the U.S.

Answers

- The subjects were "Spanish explorers" and "the first residents," the verbs were "sailed" and "were"
- The subjects were "Mexico" and "San Diego," the verbs were "won" and "became"
- The subjects were "the United States" and "San Diego," the verbs were "won" and "became"

Notice the punctuation. Where is the comma?

Clauses and Coordinating Conjunctions

A group of words that has a subject and verb is called a clause

Two or more simple sentences (clauses) may be connected to make one sentence using a comma and a coordinating conjunction

Coordinating conjunctions are also called FANBOYS. The FANBOYS are...

- For
- And
- Nor
- But
- Or
- Yet
- So

Compound Sentences

When two or more clauses are connected with a FANBOYS, the sentence is called a compound sentence

A compound sentence must have two independent clauses (SV + SV) connected by a FANBOYS

Look at the sentences below. Identify the subjects and verbs. These are not compound sentences...

- The San Diego Zoo and Balboa Park began in 1915
- Every weekend we go to the beach and enjoy the water

Answers

- The subjects were "San Diego Zoo" and "Balboa Park," the verb was "began," (compound subject)
- The subject was "we," the verbs were "go" and "enjoy," (compound verb)

Watch this video for another explanation of compound sentences.

Links on the original page

- Slides (Google Slides): https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1efKrSyb36LezmQ0Wj2D04qIFyR9-x_izIlS76TocQeg/edit?usp=sharing
- Video (YouTube): https://youtu.be/Bp2YRRotE10

2.8: Grammar: Descriptive Adjectives

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

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What is an Adjective?

An adjective modifies a noun. In other words, it gives more information about the noun, such as what kind, how many, or which one. Look at the phrases below and identify the adjective and noun...

- Rolling hills
- Majestic mountains
- Sparkling lakes

Answers

- The adjective was "rolling," the noun was "hills"
- The adjective was "majestic," the noun was mountains
- The adjective was "sparkling," the noun was "lakes"

Descriptive Adjectives

Descriptive adjectives can appear in two places in the sentence. Find the adjectives in these sentences...

- San Diego has sandy beaches
- The beaches in Sand Diego are sandy

Answers

- The descriptive adjective (sandy) comes before the noun (beaches)
- The descriptive adjective (sandy) comes after the linking verb (are)

Recognizing and Creating Adjectives

There are many adjectives in English. Adjectives make your writing more interesting, vivid, and rich. Add adjectives to your vocabulary by using them as you learn them. You can also sometimes recognize adjectives by their endings...

- -able/ible; incredible, doable, readable
- -ful; helpful, restful, doubtful
- -less; restless, helpless, doubtless
- -ic; alcoholic, realistic
- -ive; creative, active
- -al; natural, practical
- -ous; suspicious, decorous
- -ish; childish, impish

Adjectives can also be created from verbs. Some past participles and present participles can be used as adjectives...

Verb	Past participle adjective	Present participle adjective
Interest	Interested	Interesting
Tire	Tired	Tiring
Amaze	Amazed	Amazing
Fascinate	Fascinated	Fascinating
Bore	Bored	Boring

Past and Present Participle Adjectives

Past participle adjectives such as "bored," "amazed," and "interested" show that someone experiences that situation

- EX: She felt excited (she experienced excitement)

Present participle adjectives such as "boring," "amazing," and "interesting" show that the noun causes that verb

- EX: The movie was amazing (the movie caused excitement

Examples

- Verb: Frighten
  - EX: The mask is frightening. I feel frightened when I look at the mask
- Verb: Interest
  - EX: I am interested in the history of Iraq. Iraq has an interesting history
- Verb: Confuse
  - EX: The homework is confusing. All of the students felt confused by the homework
- Verb: Excite
  - EX: Disneyland is exciting. My kids are so excited about going to Disneyland

Adjective Order

Adjectives usually follow a specific order in English. The order is below...

- Determiner: A/an/the, this/that/these/those, my/your/his/her/our/their, many/both/some... etc.
- Opinion: Beautiful, ugly, hard-working, useful... etc.
- Size: Large, small, tiny, huge... etc.
- Age: Old, vintage, new, brand-new... etc.
- Shape: Round, long, thin, square... etc.
- Color: Blue, yellow, gray... etc.
- Origin: Italian, Mexican, Chinese... etc.
- Material: Woolen, cotton, wooden... etc.
- Purpose: Wedding, sleeping, swimming... etc.

It's unusual to use more than two or three adjectives before a noun

Try describing a dress, a car, and a mountain. Use at least two adjectives in the correct order. You can use adjectives from below or write your own...

- A _____ _____ dress
- A _____ _____ car
- A _____ _____ mountain

Adjectives To Choose From

- Blue
- Huge
- Beautiful
- Vintage
- Italian
- Gray
- New
- Small
- Square
- Ugly
- Hard-working
- Brand-new
- Yellow
- Useful
- Fast
- Tiny
- Long
- Mexican
- Large

- Wedding
- Majestic
- Lace
- Chinese
- Old

Comparative Adjectives

Compare two nouns using a comparative adjective. Which two nouns are compared in these sentences? What is the comparative adjective?

- San Diego, CA is larger than El Cajon, CA
- Black Mountain is higher than Mount Helix

Answers

- The two nouns are "San Diego, CA" and "El Cajon, CA" and the comparative adjective is "larger"
- The two nouns are "Black Mountain" and "Mount Helix" and the comparative adjective is "higher"

Did you notice what word follows the comparative adjective?

Answer

- Than

How Do We Make Comparative Adjectives?

One-syllable adjectives	Two-syllable adjectives ending with -y	Two-or-more-syllable adjectives	Irregular adjectives
Larger	Easier	More diverse	Good-better
Richer	Happier	More difficult	Far-farther/further
Deeper	Hungrier	More majestic	Little-less
Higher	Curlier	More populated	Many-more
Smaller	Bad-worse		
Bigger			

- If the word is one syllable, add -er to the end of the word
- If the word ends with -e, add -r
- If the word is one syllable and ends with CVC (consonant-vowel-consonant), double the final consonant
- If the word is two syllables, use "more" + adjective
- If the word is two syllables and ends with -y, drop the -y and add -ier
- Comparative adjectives are followed by "than"

Videos

- Watch this video for a clear definition of adjectives...
- Watch this video for more details about adjectives...

Links on the original page

- Slides (Google Slides): https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/12xv7bWzb1wpQvEi9_kgFXVOovgAm3DLm1Dj9vkBhuWM/edit?usp=sharing
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